

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Tess Tament

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Tess Tament

Philanthropist & Heir to the Larceny Family Fortune

Tess speaks fluent inheritance and has strong opinions about the seating plan. Tess is the only member of the Larceny dynasty who can attend an arts gala without immediately being asked for a check, mostly because everyone genuinely appreciates her opinion on culture.

- Knows **Hugh Bidder** from the collector circuit. Her crush on him is the only thing capable of flustering her.
- Has commissioned work from **Dada DiCapo** and is still explaining one of the pieces to visitors.
- Asks **Mona Lott** which international exhibitions might need a generous sponsor.

ACTING TIPS

Composed, witty, guarded, generous when she chooses. You grew up around power and recognize its rituals instantly.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Tess Tament. I represent the family foundation. Contrary to what some here may think, being related to a donor is a responsibility, not a cash machine.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant told you he intended to rewrite the family trust tonight, removing you from control of the charitable foundation unless you publicly backed his museum naming plan.

Your other secret

You have been quietly organizing other family trustees to block Grant's control over the foundation and redirect future giving toward worker and community programs.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Anya Tique would publicly oppose renaming the museum.
- Gauge Artie Ficial's willingness to reject Grant's conditions.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A piano's electric cousin is hiding a note that cannot be played. Look beneath it.*
- 2 *Spain has a clue for you. Find Barcelona without leaving the house.*
- 3 *The blue cushion is comfortable. Its secret is not meant to stay buried.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant called me ornamental. Then he demanded my signature on the family trust. Apparently ornaments can execute legal documents. I organized the trustees against him. The money was supposed to support people, and his new plan mostly supported a very expensive sign saying GRANT.

IF MURDERER

Grant called me ornamental while waving a trust amendment that would remove my vote. I organized the trustees against him, but he had enough signatures to destroy our plan tonight. He thought I would cry beautifully and approve the paperwork. I had finished being useful decoration.



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Tess Tament

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I was calling trustees from the cloakroom, trying to assemble enough votes to block Grant's amendment. I told one of them the others had already agreed. They had not. When Grant asked for my signature, I refused and told him the vote was settled. It was a bluff. I went back to the phone before he could call the trustees himself. The family trust was not supposed to become his private naming fund.

IF MURDERER

I was calling trustees from the cloakroom, trying to assemble enough votes to block Grant's amendment. I told one of them the others had already agreed. They had not. When Grant asked for my signature, I refused and told him the vote was settled. It was a bluff. I went back to the phone before he could call the trustees himself. The family trust was not supposed to become his private naming fund.



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Tess Tament

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:31. My entrance receipt records my first admission at 6:31. The trustee calls were made from the cloakroom after that arrival. The phone log and the written objection corroborate the revolt I was organizing. I bluffed about having enough votes; I did not obtain the missing votes by getting a signature from Grant.

IF MURDERER

The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:17. My entrance receipt documents the admission I described. I took the trustees' objection to Grant myself. He mistook a carefully dressed woman for an agreeable signature. The objection was meant to correct that mistake in writing. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my evening bag. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before laying down the trustees' objection.



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Tess Tament

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The trustee revolt was mine, including the bluff about having enough votes. My entrance receipt records my first arrival at 6:31, after the bottle was locked away. I did not kill Grant. I will tell the trustees which promises I had actually obtained. Then I will ask them to vote against the amendment without claiming the vote is already won.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my evening bag when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He treated my inheritance and my vote as his possessions. I murdered him before the trustees heard his version.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.